

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- 2026-05-22: SmartApeSG ClickFix --> Unidentified RAT --> NetSupport RAT
- A Russian speaker and jailbroken Gemini went on a hacking spree and emptied at least one MAGA victim's crypto wallets
- Ubiquiti patches three critical vulnerabilities in UniFi OS
- Cisco warns of AI inaccuracies in security incident reports
- Organizations knowingly ship vulnerable code amid shrinking exploit windows

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. 2026-05-22: SmartApeSG ClickFix --> Unidentified RAT --> NetSupport RAT
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Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.malware-traffic-analysis.net/2026/05/22/index.html>

02. A Russian speaker and jailbroken Gemini went on a hacking spree and emptied at least one MAGA victim's crypto wallets

Hey, Gemini, how much can we earn from one pump-and-dump cycle?

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Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/cyber-crime/2026/05/22/jailbroken-gemini-helped-russian-speaking-fraudster-target-maga-crypto-users/5245390>

03. Cisco warns of AI inaccuracies in security incident reports

Cisco's research highlights several key issues with AI-generated reports, including inconsistency and standardization challenges due to LLMs using different data for each query and producing slightly different outcomes even with the same data.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/cisco-warns-of-ai-inaccuracies-in-security-incident-reports>

04. Kash Patel's merchandise site hacked to distribute malware

The attack on Based Apparel, reportedly an attempt to distribute infostealer malware designed to steal user credentials, was first brought to light by a user on X.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/kash-patels-merchandise-site-hacked-to-distribute-malware>

05. TVs, Old York, Flipper One, Ubiquity, Underminr, CISOs, GitHub, Josh Marpet... - SWN #583

TVs, Old York, Flipper One, Ubiquity, Underminr, CISOs, GitHub, Josh Marpet... - SWN #583

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/podcast-segment/15020-tvs-old-york-flipper-one-ubiquity-undermin-cisos-github-josh-marpet-swn-583>

06. Zscaler acquires Symmetry Systems to enhance AI security

The acquisition of Symmetry Systems is expected to bolster Zscaler's cybersecurity offerings, particularly in protecting artificial intelligence applications.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/zscaler-acquires-symmetry-systems-to-enhance-ai-security>

07. Belarus-linked Ghostwriter group targets Ukraine using Prometheus learning platform lures

Ghostwriter, also known as UAC-0057 and UNC1151, employs a multi-stage attack.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/belarus-linked-ghostwriter-group-targets-ukraine-using-prometheus-learning-platform-lures>

08. Middle East malicious infrastructure report highlights concentration of C2 servers

The Hunt.io report identified over 1,350 C2 servers across 98 providers in 14 Middle Eastern countries. Saudi Telecom Company (STC) alone accounted for more than 72% of this regional activity, often through compromised customer systems.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/middle-east-malicious-infrastructure-report-highlights-concentration-of-c2-servers>

09. Megalodon chums the waters in 5.5K+ GitHub repo poisonings

Will Jason Statham save us?

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/05/22/megalodon-chums-the-waters-in-55k-github-r-epo-poisonings/5245342>

10. FBI warns of Kali Oauth stealers

The FBI has warned of the danger from a new wave of phishing attacks generated by a tool called Kali365. It enables cyber criminals to obtain Microsoft 365 access tokens and bypass multi-factor authentication (MFA) protocols without intercepting the user's credentials by capturing Oauth tokens linked to the victim's Microsoft 365 account. The scam works in...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4176464/fbi-warns-of-kali-oauth-stealers.html>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Ubiquiti patches three critical vulnerabilities in UniFi OS

The vulnerabilities, identified as CVE-2026-34908, CVE-2026-34909, and CVE-2026-34910, allow for unauthorized system changes, path traversal for accessing underlying system files, and command injection attacks, respectively.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/ubiquiti-patches-three-critical-vulnerabilities-in-unifi-os>

02. Organizations knowingly ship vulnerable code amid shrinking exploit windows

New research from Checkmarx reveals that 75% of organizations admit to frequently or sometimes deploying code they are aware is vulnerable.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/organizations-knowingly-ship-vulnerable-code-amid-shrinking-exploit-windows>

03. Drupal Vulnerability in Hacker Crosshairs Shortly After Disclosure

Drupal is warning users that it has already seen attempts to exploit CVE-2026-9082 and security firms are seeing attacks against thousands of websites. The post Drupal Vulnerability in Hacker Crosshairs Shortly After Disclosure appeared first on SecurityWeek

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/drupal-vulnerability-in-hacker-crosshairs-shortly-after-disclosure/>

04. Microsoft recognized as a Leader in The Forrester Wave™ for Workforce Identity Security Platforms

Microsoft has been recognized as a Leader in The Forrester Wave™: Workforce Identity Security Platforms, Q2 2026, receiving the highest scores in both the current offering and strategy categories. The post Microsoft recognized as a Leader in The Forrester Wave™ for Workforce Identity Security Platforms appeared first on Microsoft Security Blog .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/security/blog/2026/05/22/microsoft-recognized-as-a-leader-in-the-forrester-wave-for-workforce-identity-security-platforms/>

05. The Good, the Bad and the Ugly in Cybersecurity - Week 21

Cops seize First VPN and share intel on users, Reaper spoofs multiple brands to infect Macs, and two Microsoft Defender zero-days exploited in the wild.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/the-good-the-bad-and-the-ugly-in-cybersecurity-week-21-7/>

06. In Other News: Industrial Router Exploitation, CISA KEV Nomination Form, Gas Station Hacking

Other noteworthy stories that might have slipped under the radar: CISA contractor exposes credentials, Mythos testing and new features, Huawei router flaw triggered telecom blackout. The post In Other News: Industrial Router Exploitation, CISA KEV Nomination Form, Gas Station Hacking appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/in-other-news-industrial-router-exploitation-cisa-kev-nomination-form-gas-station-hacking/>

07. \$20 per zero-day is already the WordPress plugin reality

Vulnerability researchers have spent the past year arguing about whether AI agents can find real bugs at scale or whether they mostly generate noise. A pipeline built in three days by researchers from TrendAI and CHT Security supplies an answer, along with a price tag that the security industry will have to reckon with. The system, presented at Ekoparty Mia...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/05/22/ai-wordpress-plugin-vulnerabilities/>

08. Trend Micro warns of Apex One zero-day exploited in the wild

Japanese cybersecurity software company Trend Micro has addressed an Apex One zero-day vulnerability exploited in attacks targeting Windows systems. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/trend-micro-warns-of-apex-one-zero-day-exploited-in-attacks/>

09. Drupal: Critical SQL injection flaw now targeted in attacks

Drupal is warning that hackers are attempting to exploit a "highly critical" SQL injection vulnerability announced earlier this week. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/drupal-critical-sql-injection-flaw-now-targeted-in-attacks/>

10. Update Chrome now: Critical bugs could let attackers run code

This Chrome update fixes critical flaws attackers could exploit through malicious websites, but not the "Browser Fetch" vulnerability.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/bugs/2026/05/update-chrome-now-critical-bugs-could-let-attackers-run-code>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. Former executives plead guilty in global tech support fraud scheme

Former CEO Adam Young and former CSO Harrison Gevirtz admitted to a misprision of a felony charge. They operated C.A. Cloud Attribution, Ltd. between early 2017 and April 2022, providing services to customers known to be engaged in telemarketing and tech support fraud scams.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/former-executives-plead-guilty-in-global-tech-support-fraud-scheme>

02. Dutch authorities arrest two in connection with sanctioned web hosting company

The Dutch financial crime investigators (FIOD) arrested a 57-year-old company director and a 39-year-old who headed a separate firm providing internet connectivity.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/dutch-authorities-arrest-two-in-connection-with-sanctioned-web-hosting-company>

03. First VPN Dismantled in Global Takedown Over Use by 25 Ransomware Groups

Authorities in Europe and North America have announced the dismantling of a criminal virtual private network (VPN) service used by criminal actors to obscure the origins of ransomware attacks, data theft, scanning, and denial-of-service attacks. The disruption of First VPN Service was led by France and the Netherlands, with several other nations supporting...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/05/first-vpn-dismantled-in-global-takedown.html>

04. Netherlands seizes 800 servers of hosting firm enabling cyberattacks

Financial crime investigators in the Netherlands (FIOD) arrested two men and seized 800 servers linked to a web hosting company that enabled cyberattacks, interference operations, and disinformation campaigns. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/netherlands-seizes-800-servers-of-hosting-firm-enabling-cyberattacks/>

05. Police take down VPN service (this time with a good reason)

European authorities have cracked down on a VPN that has been used for various criminal activities. The operation, led by investigators in France and the Netherlands with help from Europol and Eurojust, has dismantled First VPN, a service that has been heavily promoted within Russia as a way of evading law enforcement. Criminals used it to conceal their identity...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4176442/police-take-down-vpn-service-this-time-with-a-good-reason-2.html>

06. Lawmakers Demand Answers as CISA Tries to Contain Data Leak

Lawmakers in both houses of Congress are demanding answers from the U.S. Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) after KrebsOnSecurity reported this week that a CISA contractor intentionally published AWS GovCloud keys and a vast trove of other agency secrets on a public GitHub account. The inquiry comes as CISA is still struggling to contain...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/05/lawmakers-demand-answers-as-cisa-tries-to-contain-data-leak/>

07. Former US execs plead guilty to aiding tech support scammers

Two former executives of a call-tracking and analytics company pleaded guilty to concealing a years-long tech support fraud scheme that victimized individuals worldwide. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/former-us-execs-plead-guilty-to-aiding-tech-support-scammers/>

08. Verizon DBIR: Healthcare Fends Off Increased Social Engineering Attacks

Ransomware and vendor breaches persist. The "2026 Data Breach Investigations Report" (DBIR) highlights how evolving social engineering tactics make the sector more

vulnerable.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/cyber-risk/verizon-dbir-healthcare-fends-off-increased-social-engineering-attacks>

09. Why Chargebacks are Just One Piece of the Fraud Puzzle

Fraud losses don't stop at chargebacks. False declines, account takeovers, and abuse also damage revenue and trust. IPQS breaks down why fraud teams need broader visibility into risk and customer impact. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/why-chargebacks-are-just-one-piece-of-the-fraud-puzzle/>

10. Canadian Man Arrested for Operating Kimwolf Botnet

Jacob Butler, 23, has been arrested in Canada and US authorities are seeking his extradition on computer hacking charges. The post Canadian Man Arrested for Operating Kimwolf Botnet appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/canadian-man-arrested-for-operating-kimwolf-botnet/>